GMS WEEKLY

Your Source for Recycling News

April 10th, 2026
Week 15
Volume 282, Issue 1230

Highlights:

- **Premium cracks.**
- **Freight firms.**
- **Dollar eases.**
- **Supply waits.**

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QUOTE of the WEEK

"The art of life lies in a constant readjustment to our surroundings."

-Kakuzo Okakura

-- MARKET COMMENTARY --

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WAR PREMIUM CRACKS

The single most consequential development of Week 15 came out of Washington, not the recycling yards. President Trump's decision to delay planned strikes on Iranian energy infrastructure by five days, alongside comments describing talks with Iran as "productive," triggered the sharpest oil reversal since the conflict began. Brent, which had held above USD 109/barrel through Q1 and into early Q2, fell to near USD 101/barrel by week's end, an almost 8% drop in a matter of hours. WTI followed, settling around USD 90/barrel. Tehran denied any negotiations even as Washington insisted talks were ongoing, highlighting just how fragile the situation remains. The Strait of Hormuz is still constrained, but markets are now pricing in the possibility of reopening, and that alone has begun to erode the war premium in energy markets.

The Baltic Dry Index rose to 2,139 by April 8th, continuing a recovery that began from the March trough and extending to its highest level since early March. Capesize earnings improved as a Brazil-to-China iron ore window opened, with the BCI C3 Brazil-to-Qingdao route briefly breaking above USD 30/metric ton for the first time since July 2024. Panamax and supramax both held gains. The improvement in freight sentiment is notable against the backdrop of the oil move. It suggests that some operators are reading the diplomatic pause as a stabilization signal rather than a durable resolution and are positioning freight accordingly. For ship recycling, a firming BDI is a headwind on the supply side. Vessel earnings continue to provide incentive to trade, not recycle.

Currency markets remained largely stable. The Indian Rupee softened slightly to 93.21, reversing part of last week's recovery, while Pakistan and Bangladesh currencies held steady. The Turkish Lira improved modestly from recent lows but remains structurally weak. A softer Dollar, with the DXY near 99.3, offers some support to sub-continent buyers heading into Q2.

For recyclers, the oil correction is important but not decisive. Lower fuel costs may eventually undermine trading economics for older vessels, but the move is still too recent to trigger immediate recycling flows. Owners are unlikely to react to a single week's volatility. The Q1 backlog of tonnage remains in place, with conditions improving but not yet compelling.

As Week 15 closes, the industry stands at a genuine inflection point, one that was not visible at the start of Q2. Whether this moment marks the beginning of supply normalization or merely a temporary reprieve in a geopolitically defined market will determine the character of Q2. Bangladesh has both the financial capacity and the pre-monsoon urgency to absorb tonnage immediately. India and Pakistan are in their strongest structural positions of the year.
The question, as it has been since the Iran war began, is when owners will act.

GMS market rankings / pricing for week 15 of 2026 are on Page 5.

BANGLADESH

THE WINDOW NARROWS

Steel spikes.

Bangladesh enters Week 15 with the sharpest improvement in steel economics seen in the quarter. Local steel plate prices jumped to BDT 71,000 per ton, the most significant single-week move of Q1–Q2, translating to a USD equivalent near USD 578/ton at current exchange rates. With the USD/BDT rate holding steady at 122.70–122.85, barely changed from 122.81–122.91 at the close of Week 14, the steel price improvement flows directly into offer capacity without the FX offset that has blunted similar gains in Alang and Aliağa. Bangladesh continues to hold its position as the sub-continent's highest bidder and its most actively engaged recycling market.

LC flow improves.

The Letter of Credit pipeline, which served as a persistent friction point on transaction velocity through Q1, continues to clear at an accelerating pace. Post-Eid central bank approvals are gathering momentum, and the structural transaction bottleneck that defined the opening quarter is meaningfully less acute entering Week 15. The two OFAC-sanctioned VLCCs at OPL Chattogram enter their fourth week unresolved. The heightened due diligence culture they have embedded across the cash buyer community shows no sign of easing, and the compliance shadow they cast over any tonnage with opaque documentation continues to slow the introduction of otherwise qualified recycling candidates to the market. A small number of similarly classified units reportedly remain in cash buyer hands.

Pre-monsoon urgency.

Bangladesh's March 2026 CPI eased to 8.71%, down from 9.13% in February, which had been the highest reading since May 2025. The moderation was driven by food price declines in the post-Eid period, while non-food inflation edged higher to 9.09%. The relative macro stability provides continued central bank flexibility on LC approvals. However, the pre-monsoon window is now the dominant operational constraint. With the June rains approximately seven weeks away, the pressure to convert appetite into executed transactions is intensifying. The oil pullback, if it signals even a partial and sustained release of the Q1 tonnage overhang, arrives at precisely the right moment. Bangladesh has both the financial positioning and the urgency to absorb tonnage rapidly. The question remains one of supply, not demand.

MARKET SALES REPORTED

VESSEL NAME	TYPE	LDT	REPORTED PRICE
HONG KONG ENERGY	LNG	31,340	USD 513/LT LDT ('as is' Linggi, Malaysia with 250 Ts bunkers)

INDIA

RUPEE GIVES BACK, SUPPLY STILL ABSENT

Rupee reversal.

India's Week 15 was defined by the partial reversal of the currency gains that had been Week 14's most positive domestic development. The USD/INR rate moved back to approximately 93.21, retracing a portion of the RBI-engineered recovery from the record low of 94.42 recorded in the prior week. The move aligns with the risk outlined in Week 14, that the INR recovery's durability was conditional on both oil price behavior and capital flow dynamics, neither of which has been resolved. The oil pullback is directionally positive for India's import bill, with approximately 70% of crude and 90% of LPG transiting outside the current Hormuz constraint, but the market is treating the diplomatic pause with appropriate caution. The rupee has accordingly given back a portion of the intervention-driven gains.

Energy drag lingers.

LPG supply disruptions at Alang's steel mills have shown only partial easing. Local steel plate prices reached INR 41,000 during the week before settling back near INR 40,600, a mid-week improvement that was not fully sustained, reflecting the uneven recovery in yard-level energy supply. At a USD equivalent of approximately USD 436/ton, India remains the lowest-priced destination in the sub-continent. This position reflects neither a lack of appetite nor infrastructure capacity, but a combination of energy disruption, unfavorable exchange rate dynamics, and the continued absence of adequate recycling tonnage flow. India's February 2026 CPI of 3.21% confirms that inflation remains well within the RBI's target band, but the LPG dependency on the Strait of Hormuz remains the key operational vulnerability. The oil pullback's long-term benefit to Alang hinges on whether the Hormuz situation resolves in a durable manner.

HKC strength.

Structurally, India's strongest differentiator heading into Q2 remains its HKC compliance infrastructure. With more than 110 yards holding valid Statements of Compliance, Alang retains unmatched capacity to process regulated European and Japanese tonnage at scale. The India CPI for March 2026 is due for release on April 13, and the RBI has formally reaffirmed its 4% inflation target with a 2–6% tolerance band for the 2026–2031 period. The broader supply challenge, insufficient inflow of recycling candidates to sustain meaningful yard activity, remains the defining constraint. Alang's readiness is not in question. Until freight markets soften and geopolitical pressures ease, the supply side will remain the story.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

PAKISTAN

STABILITY IS THE STORY

Firm footing.

Pakistan's Week 15 is characterized by one quality that has been notably scarce in the sub-continent through Q1: stability. The Pakistani Rupee has held in a narrow 278.58–279.00 range through the week, essentially unchanged from the 279.07 recorded at the close of Week 14, and local steel plate prices at PKR 177,000, with a USD equivalent of approximately USD 634/ton, have remained firm without the volatility seen in India and Bangladesh. The gap between Pakistan and India in pricing terms, approximately USD 200/ton at current levels, reaffirms Gadani's position as the sub-continent's second most competitive recycling destination. March 2026 CPI at 7.3% represents a move above the State Bank's 5–7% target, driven primarily by transport, which rose 12.5% on the month, and housing costs. This remains structurally manageable for yard economics given the stable PKR base.

Gulf proximity.

Gadani's structural positioning in a Gulf-disrupted environment continues to provide a meaningful tailwind. Ongoing regional tensions have maintained a proximity advantage for Gulf-sourced tonnage that aligns well with Gadani's yard configuration. Three HKC-certified yards are now operational, with further certifications in the pipeline, expanding Pakistan's compliance credentials and attracting growing interest from owners seeking alternatives to Alang when Indian inflow is constrained. The circulating pool of recycling candidates, including medium-sized dry bulk, LPG, and offshore units, continues to align with Gadani's available capacity and improving compliance profile.

Oil risk noted.

The one ambiguity introduced by the Week 15 oil move is the potential moderation of Gadani's Gulf proximity advantage. If a broader de-escalation of the Iran conflict takes hold, the regional dynamics that have been directing tonnage toward Pakistan may ease. For now, this remains a speculative risk rather than an immediate market reality. Pakistan enters the second half of Q2's pre-monsoon window on its firmest footing of the year, with predictable cost inputs and a competitive pricing position. The key variable, supply, is shared equally by all four destinations. Whether the oil pullback becomes the catalyst that finally releases the Q1 backlog will be the defining question of the coming weeks.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

TURKEY

BREATHING ROOM, NOT RECOVERY

Lira firms modestly.

Turkey enters Week 15 with its first modestly positive week of Q2. The Turkish lira edged from its Week 14 record low of 44.59 to approximately 44.34 against the U.S. Dollar, supported by the oil price reversal and a softer Dollar. The Central Bank of Turkey continues to operate with limited room for maneuver, having sold more than USD 8 billion in reserves during March and halting its rate-cutting cycle amid inflation pressures. These dynamics remain unchanged, and the lira has paused its slide rather than reversed it.

Inflation cools slightly.

March 2026 CPI eased to 30.87%, below both 31.53% previously and expectations of 31.4%. The softer reading was driven by slower price growth in food, housing, and education, while transport costs accelerated sharply, rising 34.35% annually and 4.52% on the month as fuel costs filtered through. Independent estimates remain significantly higher, with ENAG at 54.62% and Istanbul Chamber data at 37.68%. The central bank maintains its 16% year-end target, though this remains difficult to achieve.

Niche only.

At USD 265–285/LDT, improving marginally to about USD 268–288 on the firmer lira, Aliağa remains structurally uncompetitive for mainstream tonnage. The gap to Pakistan, at roughly USD 445–475/LDT, remains too wide to bridge. Turkey's relevance is confined to its EU-approved yards handling regulated tonnage, where compliance overrides price. Outside this segment, nothing in Week 15 suggests any meaningful shift in positioning.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

GMS Weekly – Market Rankings

For Week 15 of 2026, GMS Market Rankings / vessel indications are as below.

Rank	Location	Sentiment	Dry Bulk USD / LDT	Tankers USD / LDT	Containers USD / LDT
1	Bangladesh	**Improving**	460-465 / LDT	480-485 / LDT	490-495 / LDT
2	Pakistan	**Steady**	445-450 / LDT	465-470 / LDT	475-480 / LDT
3	India	**Steady**	430 / LDT	450 / LDT	460 / LDT
4	Turkey	**Steady**	268-270 / LDT	278-280 / LDT	288-290 / LDT

DID YOU KNOW?

- *Ship recycling at Alang has generated enough recovered steel to produce approximately 576,000 km of railway tracks, enough to circle the Earth more than 14 times.*

- *Over the years, ship recycling operations at Alang have avoided emissions equivalent to nearly 9 coal-fired power plants annually, highlighting the industry's significant environmental impact.*

- *To date, ship recycling at Alang has recovered over 69.16 million tons of steel, reducing the need to mine approximately 76 million tons of iron ore.*

IMPORTANT DATES

INDIA	
BANK HOLIDAYS	**DELIVERY TIDES**
May 01 – Buddha Purnima	April 16 – April 23 April 29 – May 06

BANGLADESH	
BANK HOLIDAYS	**DELIVERY TIDES**
April 14 – Bengali New Year	April 17 – April 20 April 30

BANK HOLIDAYS	
PAKISTAN	**TURKEY**
May 01 – Labour Day	April 23 - National Sovereignty and Children's Day

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ALANG - Port Position as of April 10, 2026

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	Stolt Cedar	11,436	Chemical Tanker	Arrived April 10
2	Stolt Sea	8,074	Chemical Tanker	Arrived April 10
3	FIR 212	730	Yatch	Arrived April 03
4	Kapid	3,300	Chemical Tanker	*Delivered April 08*
5	Seal	9,479	Oil Tanker	*Delivered April 07*
6	Bow Faith	11,060	Chemical Tanker	*Delivered April 07*
7	Bikra	4,333	Oil Tanker	*Delivered April 05*
8	D/V Diu Towed By Tug Pacific Dove	27,538	MODU	*Delivered April 05*
Morality		***75,950***		

CHATTOGRAM - Port Position as of April 10, 2026

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	Isa Golden	6,257	Bulk Carrier	Arrived April 07
2	Yu-Ying No.2	1,581	Cadet Training Ship	Arrived April 06
3	Tai Ji	3,241	Refrigerate Cargo Ship	*Delivered April 06*
4	Shuen	1,589	Container	*Delivered April 04*

GADANI - Port Position as of April 10, 2026

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
		No new vessels reported.		
Total Tonnage		**-**		

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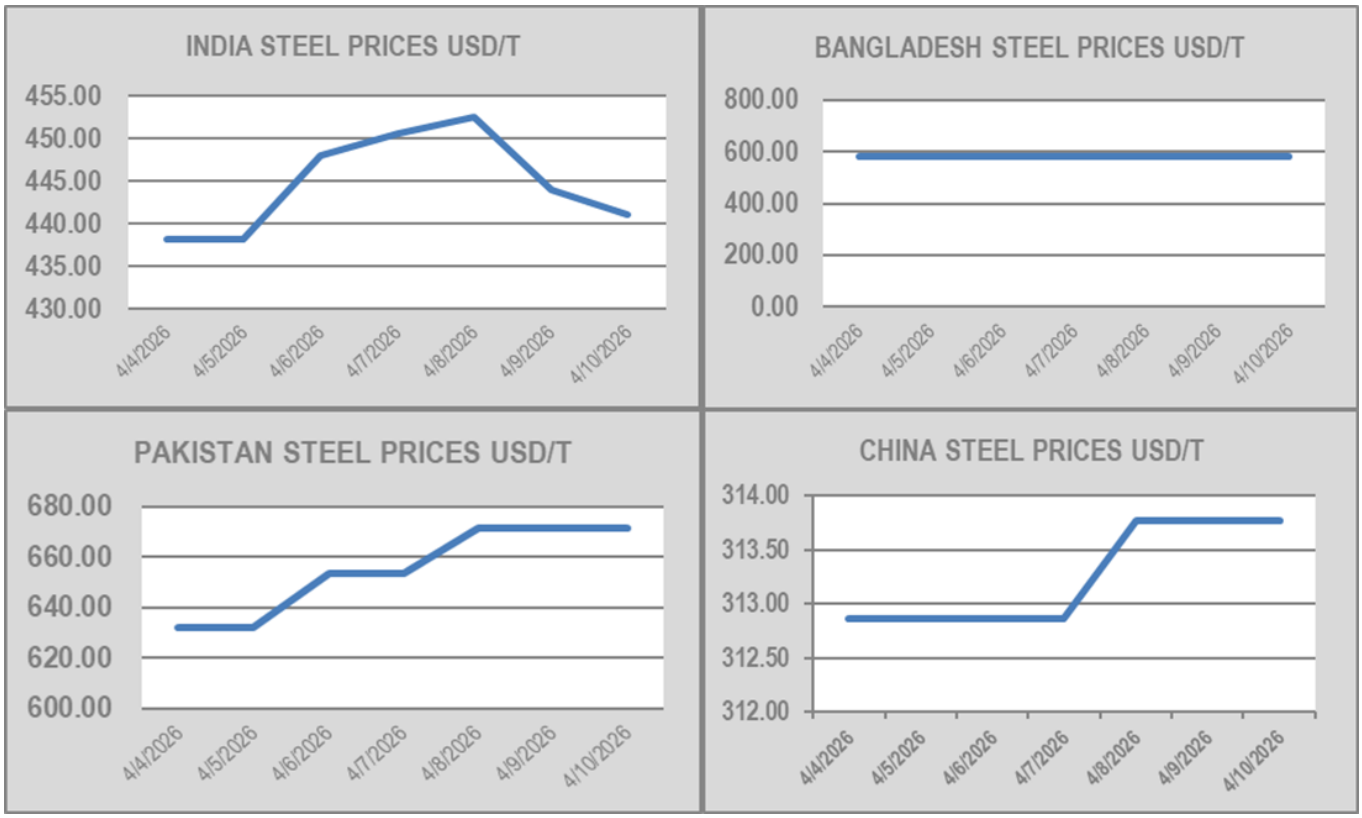
DATE	INDIA STEEL PRICES USD/T	INDIA STEEL PRICES	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES USD/T	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES USD/T	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES	CHINA STEEL PRICES USD/T
4/4/2026	438.24	40,800.00	632.14	177,000.00	584.36	71,000.00	312.86
4/5/2026	438.24	40,800.00	632.14	177,000.00	584.36	71,000.00	312.86
4/6/2026	448.10	41,700.00	653.57	183,000.00	584.36	71,000.00	312.86
4/7/2026	450.63	41,900.00	653.57	183,000.00	584.36	71,000.00	312.86
4/8/2026	452.58	41,900.00	671.43	188,000.00	584.36	71,000.00	313.77
4/9/2026	443.94	41,100.00	671.43	188,000.00	584.36	71,000.00	313.77
4/10/2026	441.16	40,900.00	671.43	188,000.00	584.36	71,000.00	313.77



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